

Product Description: [App Name TBD] – The Reactive Kitchen Feed

1. One-line pitch

A living feed of what you can cook right now, generated from your actual fridge — updated automatically every time you scan, snap, or shop, so you never open the app and search; the app tells you.

2. The Problem

Every existing "ingredients → recipes" app (including most fridge-scanning apps) is a **search tool**: you open it when you're already hungry, manually enter what you have, and get a static list back. That model has three failure points:

- **High friction** — manually listing ingredients every time is tedious, so people stop doing it after the first use
- **Rigid matching** — database-driven matching fails on real-world leftovers ("half an onion, some wilted spinach, one egg") because it's built for clean ingredient names, not messy reality
- **Reactive-only, one-off use** — nothing brings you back; there's no reason to open the app again until you're hungry and remember it exists

The result: high install, low retention — a pattern visible across the entire category.

3. The Product

Core idea: the feed, not the search box

Instead of a search experience, the app maintains a **live virtual inventory** of your kitchen and surfaces a **personalized, constantly-updating feed of what you can cook**, the same way a social feed updates when new content arrives — except here, "new content" means your ingredients changed.

The feed regenerates automatically whenever:

- You scan your fridge/pantry (photo)
- You scan a grocery receipt
- You manually add/remove/adjust an ingredient
- An ingredient is approaching its predicted expiry

Feature pillars

A. Auto-inventory (kills manual entry)

- **Fridge photo scan** — point your camera at a shelf/drawer; a vision model detects and labels visible ingredients, adds them to your inventory with an estimated quantity
- **Receipt scan** — snap your grocery receipt at checkout; items are parsed and added automatically, no manual typing
- **Manual fallback** — quick add/remove/edit for anything the scans miss or get wrong, always available, always fast

B. AI-generated recipes (kills rigid matching)

- Recipes are **generated on the fly** by an LLM using your exact current ingredients — not retrieved from a fixed database
- Handles messy, partial, leftover-style inputs naturally ("half an onion, 2 eggs, some rice" → a real recipe, not "no matches found")
- Recipes are ranked in the feed by how completely they use what you have, and how soon those ingredients expire

C. Expiry prediction (turns the app proactive)

- Each inventory item gets a predicted "use-by" window, based on typical shelf life and (later) your own historical usage patterns
- The feed proactively surfaces "use it before it goes" recipes ahead of spoilage — "Your spinach will wilt in ~2 days, here's what to make tonight"
- This is what makes the app feel like it's *watching out for you*, not just answering when asked

D. Community "fridge cleanout" content

- Users can publish their own leftover-recipe creations to a shared feed
- Community recipes are voted/ranked, so the best leftover-combos surface to everyone else
- Turns the app from a solo utility into a content platform with reasons to open it even when your own fridge is fully stocked

The unifying experience

Open the app → see a feed, already populated, already ranked by urgency and how much you already have → tap a card → cook. No search bar required for the core loop to work.

4. User Journey (MVP core loop)

1. User scans their fridge/pantry (photo) or adds items manually on first use
2. App detects/parses ingredients → populates virtual inventory

3. LLM generates a personalized recipe feed ranked by match completeness + expiry urgency
4. User taps a recipe → gets full recipe detail (ingredients, steps, optionally video/images)
5. User cooks, marks ingredients as "used," inventory updates
6. Feed regenerates instantly with the new inventory state
7. (Later) User scans a receipt after shopping → feed updates again automatically

5. Differentiation summary

	Legacy App	This app
Input	Manual ingredient list	Photo/receipt scan, auto-detected
Recipe source	Fixed database, exact-match	LLM-generated, handles messy/partial inputs
Interaction model	Search — you ask, it answers	Feed — it tells you, proactively
Expiry awareness	None	Predicts and prioritizes soon-to-expire items
Content	None	Community-submitted, voted "fridge cleanout" recipes
Retention hook	None (one-off utility)	Feed updates + expiry pushes + social content

6. Next steps

- Lock a name/brand (see rebrand options from earlier discussion)
- Build MVP scope only: manual + photo-scan inventory → LLM feed → recipe detail (defer receipt scan, expiry prediction, and community feed to later phases)